

FIRST CONGREGATIONAL CHURCH
of Los Angeles

Awakening: Life from Death
The End or Is It?
Pentecost

June 8th, 2025



Primavera Umbria, 1923 - Gerardo Dottori

540 S. Commonwealth Avenue, Los Angeles, California 90020
Telephone 213.385.1341 – www.FCCLA.org

The Gathering of the People

First Congregational Church of Los Angeles is a safe place for all people, and we celebrate our diversity of race, creed, age, ability, gender, religion, cultural background, sexual orientation, gender identities and expressions... We extend a warm welcome to all this morning and especially those who are with us for the first time. Your presence both enriches us and this time of celebration together ~

Organ Prelude Concert

Dr. Christoph Bull, Organist-in- Residence

Hymn Improvisation

Meditation on *Veni Creator Spiritus*

Komm, Heil'ger Geist (Friedrich Wilhelm Zachow)

Allegro in C Major (Thomas René Babou) and Improvisation

Come God Creator, Holy Spirit, BWV 631 (Johann Sebastian Bach) and Improvisation

Toccata in D minor and Fugue in D Major, Opus 59 No. 5-6 (Max Reger)

Chiming of the Hour

Welcome

Rev. Chad Tanaka Pack

Pentecost Words of Gathering

Rev. Tanaka Pack, Katherine & Jason Lambert

Come, from every corner of the earth,
from every time and place
from south and north
from east and west
gather
gather
gather here in this time
and in this place.

For the Spirit of God is being poured out upon us
even now
upon the young and the old
upon our children
upon our siblings
of every color and nation
sexual orientation and gender identities
Upon each one of us gathered here!

We come from different places to this sacred place
of communal caring and celebration.

In the times which we now share
may we be open to the Creative Spirit of our God,
the Spirit of kindness and compassion.

In this time of worship,
may we be enriched by the company of each other,
and be drawn closer to the heart of life.

May it be so.
May it be so for all of us!

Please stand in body or in spirit for our Hymn of Gathering

***Pentecost Hymn of Gathering** *O Spirit of Power*

LYONS

O Spirit of Power, who dwells in us all,
Inspire us each hour to follow your call.
Awaken our vision to all we can be,
And challenge our labor to set people free.

Though many your names, Love reigns over all;
With you we can claim our life giving call.
Cast out all our fear so with you we can soar,
Creating a world never dreamed of before.

O Spirit of Love, compassionate Friend,
Within and above, your strength knows no end.
Your rivers of healing revive thirsty land;
All goodness and nourishment flow from your hand.

O Spirit of Power, O Love beyond thought,
Our gifts with you flower; what wonders are wrought.
Creator, Redeemer and Comforting Guide,
Illumine our lives as with you we abide.

- lyrics by Jann Aldredge-Clanton [1946-2024]

***Prayer of Awareness**

Rev. Laura Vail Fregin

Spirit of the Living God, in you all things are in motion.
Where change is needed in our thinking or our beliefs,
in our practices or our ways of relating to each other,
be our guide.

Give us courage to stay present to that which
makes us uncomfortable.
Give us patience when we are unsettled.
Give us strength when we face loss.
Give us the faith to welcome necessary change,
eagerly or tepidly, for the sake of your dream for us.
[adpt/enfleshed]

May it be so.
May it be so for all of us!
Amen and Amen.

***Introit**

"A Festive Intrada"
Cathedral Ringers, Grace Sheldon-Williams, *Director*

CYNTHIA DOBRINSKI

***The Lord's Prayer**

Rev. Tanaka Pack

*Holy One, beyond all names,
Eternal Wellspring,
May love rise again in us today
with food for every table,
shelter for every family,
and reverence for every life.
Forgive us our failings in love
and free us from all falseness,
that the light of our souls may shine,
and the strength of our spirits endure
for Earth and all its people
This day, tonight, and forever.
Amen and Amen!* [John Philip Newell]

***Gloria Deo**

Glory be to God, and to the Christ and to the Holy Ghost,
As it was in the beginning, is now and ever shall be.
World without end, Amen, Amen.

***Passing of the Peace**

Jason & Katherine Lambert

The spirit of imagination is a gift to all people.
The spirit of faithfulness is the gift of the earth.
The spirit of hope breathes
in those who are marginalized in this city
and throughout the world.

The spirit of freedom
was announced by those who went before us
and we proclaim it again today,
because the Spirit of Love is Christ's
gift to the church in every age.

This morning may we recognize:
*the love of the Spirit of God in Scripture,
the love of the Spirit of God among us,
the love of the Spirit of God within us.*

This morning, may the Peace and Power of God be with you.
And also with you!

You are invited to share this ancient greeting with a bow.

Please be seated

Reading from Our Religious Tradition *The Pentecost Story*
from the Book of Acts, chapter 2.1-13

Rev. Tanaka Pack & Claire Kelly

This is the witness of the people.
Thanks be to God!

Children's Pentecost Conversation

Claire Kelly

Following this conversation, children are invited to join us for our Sunday morning programming which is held outside near the playground. If you were unable to check your children in prior to the service, please accompany them to our Children's Area in the narthex and check them in before returning to the service. Children must be picked up after worship before you head to Coffee Hour in the Courtyard.

Prayers with the People

Rev. Tanaka Pack

Invitation to Silence and Prayer

Listen now to this invitation:

We come from many different places to this sacred place
of communal caring and celebration.

In the time which we now share
may we be open to the Creative Spirit
of kindness and compassion.

And may we be enriched by the company of each other,
and drawn closer to the heart of life.

As today we remember the Spirit of Life
who comes to us on the wings of the wind,
together, may we open our hearts, our minds, and our bodies,
to this time of meditation and prayer.

Silence

Prayers of Our Hearts

Holy One, on this day of Pentecost, we gather in celebration of your Spirit.
From deep within us, and from our daily lives,
and beyond this world and the next,
we are touched by this Spirit of Life.

By the power of the Spirit, our faith is born.
And like the first Christians so long ago,
we have many languages for faith, and many gifts of the Spirit.

Today, in this our sacred space, we speak from our hearts,
of what we know and love.

Today, in this our sacred space, we speak from our minds,
of our doubts, of our skepticism,
as we search for truths to live by.

Today, in this our sacred space, we speak from our faith,
be it fragile or firm; we speak how it shapes our lives.

Today, in this our sacred space, we speak from compassion,
as we reach out to each other,
and as together...we stretch for understanding.

So come now, Holy Spirit, come,
and breathe into our hearts this day.
Bless and inspire this sacred time
that we may live Spirit-filled lives
of love and compassion for all.

May it ever be so.
May it ever be so for all of us!
Amen and Amen.

Meditation Anthem

Fantasy on "Immortal, Invisible"
Cathedral Ringers, Grace Sheldon-Williams, *Director*

DOUGLAS FLOYD SMITH

Sermon

The End - Or is It?

Rev. Fregin

Invitation to Generosity

Jason Lambert

At First Church, we consider every pledge, tithe, offering and contribution a gift for the life of our community of faith. No matter how it's given, our gifts show gratitude. You are invited to visit our website at fccla.org/give. Our hospitality team will also be available at the exits when the service ends with baskets to collect gifts.

Our hospitality team will bring baskets to you for your offerings, or you can use the QR Code in your programs and appearing now on your screens.

Offertory

RALPH VAUGHAN WILLIAMS

"Nation Shall Not Lift Sword Against Nation" from *Dona Nobis Pacem*
Cathedral Choir, Dr. Fahad Siadat, *Assistant Conductor*

***Doxology**

From all that dwell below the skies,
let the Creator's praise arise!
Alleluia! Alleluia!
Your name shall sound and praises soar
till suns shall rise and set no more.
Alleluia! Alleluia!
Alleluia! Alleluia! Alleluia!

[adapt/Isaac Watts, 1719]

***Prayer of Offering**

Katherine Lambert

*Spirit of Life and Hope,
we sense your presence in this place.
Awaken us again to the mysteries that humble us,
the realities that orient us,
the friendships that sustain us,
that we may give ourselves in honesty and openness
to the expanding life before us!*

May it ever be so.
May it ever be so for all of us.
Amen and Amen!

Please be seated

Life at First Church

Rev. Fregin

Words of Blessing

Rev. Fregin

God has gathered us together for a purpose –
a living, moving, breathing purpose
that calls us to live differently,
to live passionately,
and to live courageously.

With the Spirit as our guide, let us go from here
open to the wild ways of God,
however and in whomever She may be revealed.

May it be so.

May it be so for all of us!

Choral Response

"The Rising"

BRUCE SPRINGSTEEN, arr. DAVID HARRIS

Cathedral Choir, Dr. Fahad Siadat, *Assistant Conductor*, Steve Gregoropoulos, *Piano*

***Hymn for the Journey**

Come, O Fount Of Every Blessing

NETTLETON

Come, O Fount of every blessing,
Tune my heart to sing your grace;
Streams of mercy, never ceasing,
Call for songs of endless praise.
Teach me some melodious sonnet,
Sung by flaming tongues above.
Praise the mount; I'm fixed upon it,
Mount of God's unfailing love.

Here I pause in my sojourning,
Giving thanks for having come,
Come to trust, at every turning,
God will guide me safely home.
Jesus sought me when a stranger,
Wandering from the fold of God,
Came to rescue me from danger,
Blessed body, precious love.

O to grace how great a debtor
Daily I am drawn anew!
Let that grace now, like a fetter,
Bind my wandering heart to you.
Prone to wander, I can feel it,
Wander from the love I've known:
Here's my heart, O take and seal it,
Seal it for your very own.

Please be seated for the Postlude

Postlude

Dr. Christoph Bull, *Organist-in-Residence*
Komm, Heiliger Geist, Herre Gott (G.P. Telemann)

Inside The Music

“With militarism, one of the three societal ills according to Dr. Martin Luther King, on the rise, a call for peace becomes a powerful message of disruption.

The center of today’s service music is the final movement of Ralph Vaughan William’s *Dona Nobis Pacem*, an urgent cry for peace created in the months immediately preceding World War II. Vaughan Williams, who served on the front lines of World War I as a volunteer ambulance driver and then artillery officer, was intimately familiar with the horrors of war.

The text is taken from sources across the Bible, but the opening words “Nation shall not lift up a sword against nation, neither shall they learn war any more” is the central message of the work.

The service ends with Bruce Springsteen’s “The Rising” a joyful call to join the populist resistance against authoritarianism.” -Dr. Fahad Siadat